

Gnome 3 coming soon

The final version of Gnome 3 is expected to arrive this month itself, and Fedora 15 is likely to be the first Linux distribution to ship with it

3D hardware required

Gnome 3 requires supported 3D hardware to be present. In some cases this can mean having to install proprietary drivers for your card

Workshop

Active application

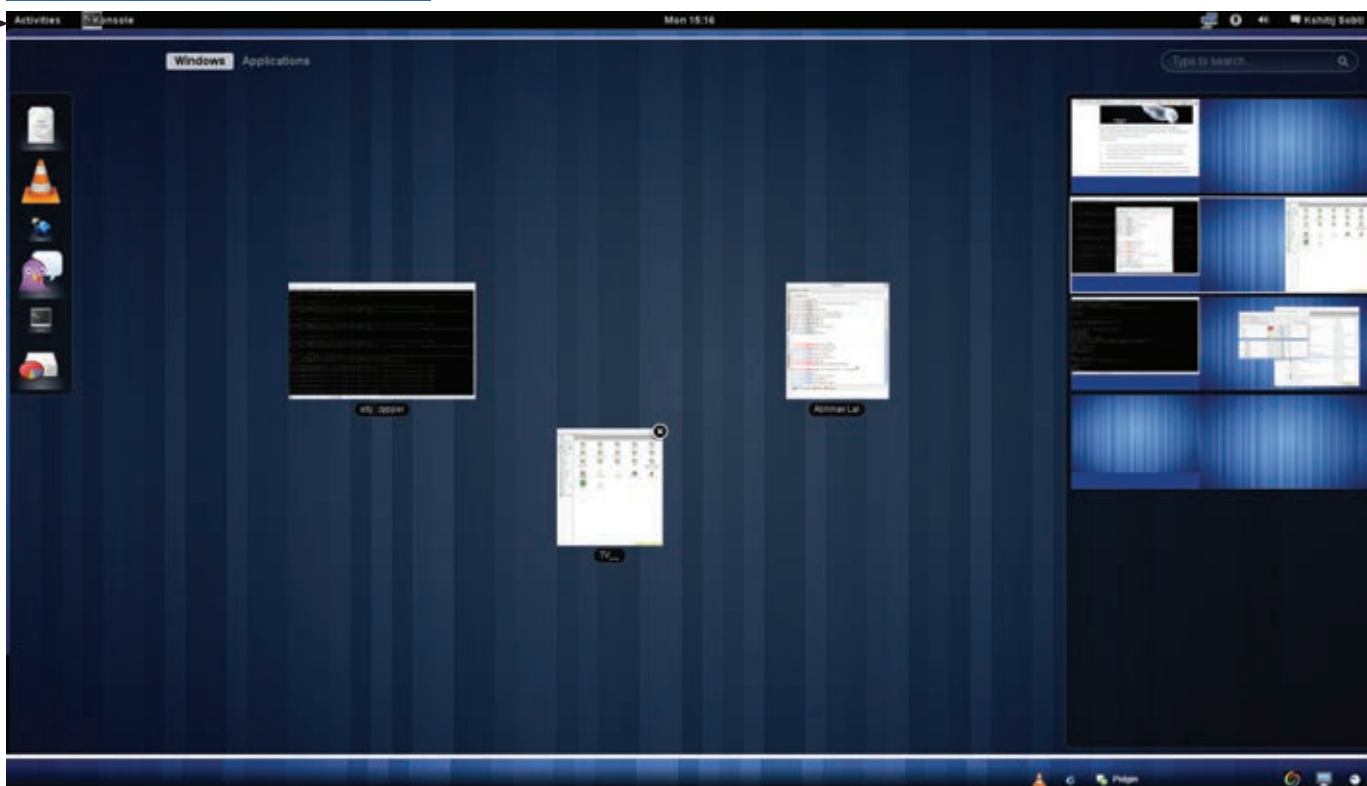
The Gnome menubar shows the currently active task with a zoomed in icon. This is to make it clear which application has focus. Clicking on it will reveal a menu of actions that apply to the entire application. Currently most of the applications we tried just showed “Quit”. Unlike a taskbar, this only shows one task, the active one, and the actions apply to the entire application, not the current window. So if you Quit Firefox from here it will close the entire app, not just the active window.

Clock

Clicking on this will drop down a calendar that is integrated with Evolution — an open-source alternative to Microsoft Outlook — such that your calendar entries will display here.

System Icons

Gnome distinguishes between core system icons, and those created by other applications. This area will just display system icons, such as blue-tooth, WiFi / network connectivity, battery indicator, volume etc. All your other icons, such as those for applications you install will show up at the bottom-right corner.



When you launch the Activities view, you can straight-away start typing — without even switching to the applications view — to get matching applications.

The search mechanism leaves a lot to be desired. It is utterly unintelligent! For example, we searched for “terminal” in order to launch the Gnome Terminal, however the first entry we got was or a remote terminal app. Despite typing `ter`

`mina` and starting the Gnome Terminal a number of times, Gnome still lists the remote terminal application first.

Automatic workspaces

Gnome 3 features a brilliant workspace management feature called automatic workspaces. Traditionally, you’d have a fixed number of workspaces (or virtual desktops) that they could use to arrange

windows. Moblin introduced a new concept where workspaces were created dynamically as one launches applications. This concept has been followed — with a few changes — in Gnome 3 as well. You start off with one workspace in which your applications launch. You can go into overview mode, and move application to a new workspace, such that there are never two empty workspaces. 